

METHODOLOGY

How the Colleges are Ranked



Photograph: HEMANT CHAWLA. Models: Preeti Chauhan, Ashish Bhat and Asmita Sood. Make up: Satish and Monisha. Styling: Shreshth Jasti. Clothes: Park Avenue and Esprit. Location Courtesy: Miranda House, Delhi/www.indiatodayimages.com

The INDIA TODAY annual survey of colleges and institutes offering arts, science, commerce, law, engineering and medicine to identify the best colleges in their respective fields is in its 14th year. A team of The Nielsen Company partnered with INDIA TODAY and worked on a formula based on a perception score (from an opinion poll conducted among academic experts) and a factual score (from the factual data furnished by colleges) to determine the best undergraduate colleges in India in these six disciplines.

For arts, science and commerce, colleges in 12 major cities—Ahmedabad, Bangalore, Chandigarh, Chennai, Delhi, Hyderabad, Jaipur, Kochi, Kolkata, Lucknow, Mumbai and Pune—were considered while for engineering, medicine and law, colleges from all over the country were considered.

The process began in December 2009 when secondary research was done to generate the list of colleges for the survey using secondary data sources such as the Internet, published reports and the Association of Indian Universities Handbook. A comprehensive list of more than 1,500 colleges was drawn up which was Step 1 of the survey process.

After comprehensive lists in each of the streams were compiled, experts in each city were administered a structured questionnaire. They were asked to distribute 100 points across five vital parameters—Reputation of College, Quality of Academic Input, Student Care, Infrastructure and Job Prospects. After collating their individual responses, weightage of each of these parameters was arrived at.

The experts were then asked to rate the colleges in their city for arts, science, commerce and in their respective zones (north, south, east and west) for engineering, medicine and law. To eliminate bias, they were not allowed to rate their own college. The overall perceptual score of a college was calculated on the basis of the rating given by experts on the above mentioned five criteria weighted by their importance. This concluded Step 2 of the study.

On the basis of the output from Step 2, list of colleges to be evaluated on national level was obtained. A different panel of experts was asked to rate the colleges in their respective streams, this time with a national perspective. This yielded the perceptual scores of colleges in each of the six streams on a national level. Step 3 of the study.

To determine the overall rankings, colleges that figured in Top 50 in arts, science and commerce streams and Top 25 in engineering, medicine and law streams were contacted for factual data. The colleges which declined to provide the factual data were not considered in the final ranking process. It was also decided not to consider faculties of universities for streams